

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7)

Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	8 — हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Questions test the subhashitas on speech, effort and action. Watch the classic traps: च means 'AND' (both useful AND pleasing), not 'or'; दुर्लभम् means RARE / hard-to-find, not impossible (अशक्यम्); knowledge is gathered क्षणशः (moment by moment) and wealth कणशः (particle by particle), one adverb per noun; क्रियावान् (a doer) is preferred over विकृत्यन् (a boaster); and सूक्तिः (a good saying) is not सूक्ष्म (subtle). Sanskrit is quoted in Devanagari. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः means:

- (A) all speech is useless (B) pleasing speech is common
(C) useful speech is impossible
(D) rare is speech that is both useful and pleasing

2. वचः in the verse means:

- (A) action (B) speech / words
(C) wealth (D) curiosity

3. हितम् means:

- (A) pleasing (B) rare
(C) beneficial / useful (D) boastful

4. मनोहारि means:

- (A) pleasing (heart-stealing) (B) useful
(C) rare (D) harmful

5. The verse says such speech (both useful and pleasing) is:

- (A) common (B) impossible
(C) useless (D) दुर्लभम् (rare)

6. The particle च in हितं मनोहारि च means:

- (A) 'and' (both qualities together) (B) 'or' (either one)
(C) 'not' (D) 'why'

7. Mistranslating च as 'or' weakens the verse because it would:

- (A) make no difference (B) make the verse harder
(C) lower a near-impossible 'both' standard to an easy 'either' one
(D) change हितम् into मनोहारि

8. In Sanskrit, का, वा and च mean, respectively:

- (A) 'and', 'or', 'what' (B) 'or', 'and', 'what'
(C) interrogative ('what/which'), 'or', and 'and' (D) 'what', 'and', 'or'

9. Because of च, the rare speech must be:

- (A) both beneficial AND pleasing at once (B) either beneficial or pleasing
(C) only beneficial (D) only pleasing

10. Speech that is pleasing but harmful, or useful but harsh, is:

- (A) exactly the rare ideal (B) always impossible
(C) NOT the rare ideal the verse praises (D) the same as boasting

11. दुर्लभम् means:

- (A) impossible (B) common
(C) easy (D) rare / hard to find

12. The verse implies that speech both useful and pleasing is:

- (A) completely impossible (B) achievable, just hard
(C) very common (D) never worth attempting

13. Sanskrit distinguishes दुर्लभम् from अशक्यम्; अशक्यम् means:

- (A) rare but possible (B) impossible
(C) easy (D) pleasing

14. The verse's encouragement is that the ideal speech is hard but:

- (A) truly impossible (B) not worth the effort
(C) not impossible (D) already common

15. Calling something दुर्लभम् rather than अशक्यम् tells a student to:

- (A) give up, since it is impossible (B) keep striving, since it is rare but attainable
(C) relax, since it is easy (D) ignore it

16. Beneficial speech (हितम्) is speech that:

- (A) merely flatters (B) does good / helps the listener
(C) is always harsh (D) is impossible to give

17. Pleasing speech (मनोहारि) is speech that:

- (A) is harsh and hurtful
(C) is always false

- (B) is agreeable and wins the heart
(D) cannot be understood

18. The hardest speech to achieve combines:

- (A) being harsh and false
(B) being long and loud
(C) being helpful and being pleasant at the same time
(D) being silent and still

19. A kind word that also gives good advice is an example of speech that is:

- (A) both हितम् and मनोहारि
(B) neither हितम् nor मनोहारि
(C) only boastful
(D) impossible

20. क्षणशः means:

- (A) particle by particle
(B) all at once
(C) never
(D) moment by moment

21. कणशः means:

- (A) moment by moment
(B) all at once
(C) backwards
(D) particle by particle

22. The -शस् suffix in क्षणशः / कणशः makes adverbs meaning:

- (A) 'all at once'
(B) 'by units of' (one by one)
(C) 'never'
(D) 'to / for'

23. क्षणशः and कणशः are best described as:

- (A) a single word
(B) two verbs
(C) two adverbs, one per noun
(D) two nouns in the dative

24. According to the verse, knowledge (विद्या) should be gathered:

- (A) कणशः (particle by particle)
(B) all at once
(C) never
(D) क्षणशः (moment by moment)

25. Wealth (अर्थ) should be gathered:

- (A) क्षणशः (moment by moment)
(B) कणशः (particle by particle)
(C) all in one day
(D) by boasting

26. The verse 'क्षणशः कणशः' teaches that both knowledge and wealth grow:

- (A) instantly
(B) by luck alone
(C) gradually, little by little
(D) without any effort

27. क्रियावान् means:

- (A) one of action (a doer)
(B) a boaster
(C) a curious person
(D) a treasure

28. क्रियावान् breaks into क्रिया + वान्, meaning:

- (A) 'speech' + 'possessing' (B) 'wealth' + 'lacking'
(C) 'action' + 'possessing' = action-possessing (D) 'boast' + 'possessing'

29. विकत्थनम् / विकत्थन means:

- (A) action / a doer (B) boasting / a boaster
(C) curiosity (D) a good saying

30. The verse contrasts क्रियावान् with:

- (A) सूक्तिः (a good saying) (B) कुतूहलम् (curiosity)
(C) विकत्थन (the boaster) (D) भाण्डागारः (a treasure)

31. Between a doer (क्रियावान्) and a boaster (विकत्थन), the chapter prefers the:

- (A) boaster (B) neither
(C) both equally (D) doer (one of action)

32. The chapter's preference for क्रियावान् reflects Sanskrit's general preference for:

- (A) speech over deeds (B) deeds (कर्म) over mere speech (कथन)
(C) boasting over action (D) silence over everything

33. A student who quietly does the work, rather than bragging about it, is a:

- (A) क्रियावान् (one of action) (B) विकत्थन (a boaster)
(C) कुलकलङ्कः (a family-stain) (D) शृगालः (a fox)

34. सूक्तिः means:

- (A) a good / well-said saying (B) a subtle thing
(C) a boast (D) a treasure

35. सूक्तिः breaks into सु + उक्ति, meaning:

- (A) 'subtle' + 'thing' (B) 'well' + 'saying' = a well-spoken saying
(C) 'six' + 'fault' (D) 'action' + 'possessing'

36. सूक्तिः is a synonym of:

- (A) सुभाषितम् (a wise saying) (B) विकत्थनम् (boasting)
(C) भाण्डागारः (treasure) (D) शृगालः (fox)

37. सूक्तिः and सूक्ष्म both start with सू-, but सूक्ष्म means:

- (A) a good saying (B) a boast
(C) curiosity (D) subtle / fine / minute

38. Confusing सूक्तिः with सूक्ष्म is wrong because they come from:

- (A) the same root
(B) different roots (उक्ति 'saying' vs the stem सूक्ष्म)
(C) the same meaning (D) the same verb

39. कुतूहलम् means:

- (A) boasting (B) character
(C) curiosity / eagerness to know (D) wealth

40. कुतूहलम् is glossed as कौतुकम्, meaning:

- (A) boredom (B) anger
(C) curiosity / eagerness (D) laziness

41. कुतूहलम् is a close cousin of which word from Chapter 1?

- (A) जिज्ञासा (the wish to know) (B) वन्दे (I salute)
(C) आम्लम् (sour) (D) शीलम् (character)

42. The chapter holds कुतूहलम् up as a virtue of:

- (A) a boaster (B) a learner
(C) a lazy person (D) a king

43. भाण्डागारः means:

- (A) a boast (B) curiosity
(C) a treasure-trove / storehouse (D) a good saying

44. Calling knowledge or good sayings a भाण्डागारः suggests they are:

- (A) a precious store to be treasured (B) worthless
(C) a burden (D) impossible to gather

45. A library full of wise books could be called a भाण्डागारः of:

- (A) boasting (B) laziness
(C) sourness (D) knowledge

46. शीलम्, revisited in this chapter, means:

- (A) wealth (B) speech
(C) curiosity (D) character / moral conduct

47. Through all the advice on speech and effort, what the chapter says truly counts is:

- (A) शीलम् (character) (B) boasting
(C) wealth alone (D) loud speech

48. That शीलम् appears again (after Chapter 6) shows the chapters share a value:

- (A) wealth above all (B) good character above outward things
(C) boasting as a virtue (D) silence as the only goal

49. A person of fine speech and effort but bad character would still lack the chapter's core value of:

- (A) शीलम् (character) (B) वचः (speech)
(C) कुतूहलम् (curiosity) (D) अर्थ (wealth)

50. Which word-meaning pair is CORRECT?

- (A) विकृत्यन = a doer (B) सूक्तिः = boasting
(C) दुर्लभम् = impossible (D) क्रियावान् = one of action

51. Which adverb pair is CORRECT?

- (A) क्षणशः = all at once (B) कणशः = moment by moment
(C) क्षणशः = moment by moment; कणशः = particle by particle
(D) both mean instantly

52. Which 'rare speech' pair is CORRECT?

- (A) हितम् = pleasing; मनोहारि = useful (B) हितम् = boastful
(C) हितम् = useful; मनोहारि = pleasing (D) मनोहारि = harsh

53. Which subtle-distinction pair is CORRECT?

- (A) सूक्तिः = subtle; सूक्ष्म = a saying (B) दुर्लभम् = impossible; अशक्यम् = rare
(C) च = or; वा = and (D) सूक्तिः = a good saying; सूक्ष्म = subtle/fine

54. The overall theme of these subhashitas is:

- (A) wise speech, steady effort, action over boasting, and good character
(B) a fox and grapes (C) banking and finance
(D) the names of the Sun

55. The verse on speech and the verse on क्षणशः-कणशः together teach that good things are:

- (A) rare/hard but achievable through steady, patient effort
(B) easy and instant (C) impossible and pointless
(D) gained only by boasting

56. Preferring the क्रियावान् to the विकृत्यन teaches that we should:

- (A) boast rather than act (B) stay silent always
(C) gather wealth dishonestly (D) act rather than merely boast

57. The learner's virtue कुतूहलम् supports the chapter's message by:

- (A) encouraging boasting (B) discouraging effort
(C) replacing character (D) driving the patient gathering of knowledge

58. Putting it together, हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः is best understood as:

- (A) speech both useful (हितम्) AND pleasing (मनोहारि) is rare (but achievable)
(B) speech either useful or pleasing is common (C) useful speech is impossible
(D) pleasing speech is always harmful

59. The chapter's vocabulary (सूक्तिः, कुतूहलम्, भाण्डागारः, शीलम्) supports its message by valuing:

- (A) boasting, laziness, and harsh speech
(B) good sayings, curiosity, treasured knowledge, and character
(C) wealth and pride only (D) silence and inaction

60. A student claims: 'च means or, so the verse needs only useful OR pleasing speech, and दुर्लभम् means impossible.' The best correction is:

- (A) the student is fully correct (B) च means 'and', and दुर्लभम् means impossible
(C) च means 'or', and दुर्लभम् means rare
(D) च means 'and' (both useful AND pleasing), and दुर्लभम् means rare/hard, not impossible

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks 240.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	D	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	C
2	B	12	B	22	B	32	B	42	B	52	C
3	C	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	C	53	D
4	A	14	C	24	D	34	A	44	A	54	A
5	D	15	B	25	B	35	B	45	D	55	A
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	A	46	D	56	D
7	C	17	B	27	A	37	D	47	A	57	D
8	C	18	C	28	C	38	B	48	B	58	A
9	A	19	A	29	B	39	C	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	D	30	C	40	C	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (D)** The verse means rare is speech that is both useful (हितम्) and pleasing (मनोहारि). The other readings distort it.
- (B)** वचः means 'speech / words'. Action is क्रिया, wealth अर्थ, and curiosity कुतूहलम्.
- (C)** हितम् means 'beneficial / useful'. Pleasing is मनोहारि, rare दुर्लभम्, and boastful विकृत्यन.
- (A)** मनोहारि means 'pleasing' (heart-stealing). Useful is हितम्, rare दुर्लभम्, and harmful अहितम्.
- (D)** Such speech is दुर्लभम् (rare). It is not common, impossible, or useless.
- (A)** च means 'and', demanding both qualities together. It is not 'or', 'not', or 'why'.
- (C)** Reading च as 'or' would lower the demanding 'both' standard to an easy 'either' one. It does make a difference and does not make the verse harder.

- 8. (C)** का is interrogative, वा is 'or', and च is 'and'. The other orderings are wrong.
- 9. (A)** च requires the speech to be both beneficial and pleasing at once. Not either-or, only useful, or only pleasing.
- 10. (C)** Pleasing-but-harmful or useful-but-harsh speech is NOT the rare both-and-both ideal. It is not the ideal, impossible, or boasting.
- 11. (D)** दुर्लभम् means 'rare / hard to find'. It does not mean impossible, common, or easy.
- 12. (B)** It is achievable but hard (दुर्लभम्). It is not impossible, common, or not worth attempting.
- 13. (B)** अशक्यम् means 'impossible', while दुर्लभम् means 'rare but possible'. It is not easy or pleasing.
- 14. (C)** The ideal is hard but not impossible. It is not truly impossible, pointless, or already common.
- 15. (B)** दुर्लभम् (rare but attainable) tells a student to keep striving - not give up, relax, or ignore it.
- 16. (B)** हितम् speech does good and helps the listener. It is not mere flattery, always harsh, or impossible.
- 17. (B)** मनोहारि speech is agreeable and wins the heart. It is not harsh, false, or unintelligible.
- 18. (C)** The hardest combines being helpful AND pleasant at once. Not harsh-and-false, long-and-loud, or silent.
- 19. (A)** A kind word that also advises well is both हितम् (useful) and मनोहारि (pleasing). Not neither, boastful, or impossible.
- 20. (D)** क्षणशः means 'moment by moment'. कणशः is 'particle by particle'; it is not 'all at once' or 'never'.
- 21. (D)** कणशः means 'particle by particle'. क्षणशः is 'moment by moment'; it is not 'all at once' or 'backwards'.
- 22. (B)** The -शस् suffix makes 'by units of' adverbs (one by one). Not 'all at once', 'never', or 'to/for'.
- 23. (C)** They are two adverbs, one per noun (knowledge, wealth). They are not one word, two verbs, or datives.

- 24. (D)** Knowledge is gathered क्षणशः (moment by moment). Wealth is कणशः; it is not gathered all at once or never.
- 25. (B)** Wealth is gathered कणशः (particle by particle). Knowledge is क्षणशः; not all in one day or by boasting.
- 26. (C)** Both grow gradually, little by little. Not instantly, by luck, or without effort.
- 27. (A)** क्रियावान् is one of action (a doer). A boaster is विकथन, a curious person कुतूहली, and a treasure भाण्डागारः.
- 28. (C)** क्रिया ('action') + वान् ('possessing') = action-possessing (a doer). The other splits are wrong.
- 29. (B)** विकथन means boasting / a boaster. A doer is क्रियावान्, curiosity कुतूहलम्, and a good saying सूक्तिः.
- 30. (C)** It contrasts the doer (क्रियावान्) with the boaster (विकथन). Not with a saying, curiosity, or a treasure.
- 31. (D)** The chapter prefers the doer (क्रियावान्). Not the boaster, neither, or both equally.
- 32. (B)** It reflects a preference for deeds (कर्म) over mere speech (कथन). Not speech over deeds, boasting, or pure silence.
- 33. (A)** Quietly doing the work makes one a क्रियावान् (one of action). Not a boaster, a family-stain, or a fox.
- 34. (A)** सूक्तिः is a good / well-said saying. A subtle thing is सूक्ष्म, a boast विकथन, and a treasure भाण्डागारः.
- 35. (B)** सु ('well') + उक्ति ('saying') = a well-spoken saying. The other splits are wrong.
- 36. (A)** सूक्तिः is a synonym of सुभाषितम् (a wise saying). It is not boasting, treasure, or a fox.
- 37. (D)** सूक्ष्म means 'subtle / fine / minute'. A good saying is सूक्तिः, a boast विकथन, and curiosity कुतूहलम्.
- 38. (B)** They come from different roots (उक्ति 'saying' vs सूक्ष्म 'subtle'). They are not from the same root, meaning, or verb.
- 39. (C)** कुतूहलम् means 'curiosity / eagerness to know'. Boasting is विकथन, character शीलम्, and wealth अर्थ.
- 40. (C)** कुतूहलम् = कौतुकम् = 'curiosity / eagerness'. It is not boredom, anger, or laziness.

41. (A) कुतूहलम् is close to जिज्ञासा (the wish to know). वन्दे, आम्लम् and शीलम् are unrelated to curiosity.
42. (B) कुतूहलम् (curiosity) is held up as a learner's virtue. Not a boaster's, a lazy person's, or a king's.
43. (C) भाण्डागारः is a treasure-trove / storehouse. A boast is विकथन, curiosity कुतूहलम्, and a good saying सूक्तिः.
44. (A) Calling them a भाण्डागारः suggests a precious store to be treasured. Not worthless, a burden, or ungatherable.
45. (D) A library of wise books is a भाण्डागारः of knowledge. Not of boasting, laziness, or sourness.
46. (D) शीलम् means 'character / moral conduct'. Wealth is अर्थ, speech वचः, and curiosity कुतूहलम्.
47. (A) What truly counts is शीलम् (character). Not boasting, wealth alone, or loud speech.
48. (B) Repeating शीलम् shows a shared value: good character above outward things. Not wealth, boasting, or pure silence.
49. (A) Such a person still lacks शीलम् (character), even with fine speech and effort.
50. (D) क्रियावान् = one of action. विकथन is a boaster (not a doer), सूक्तिः a good saying (not boasting), and दुर्लभम् rare (not impossible).
51. (C) क्षणशः = moment by moment and कणशः = particle by particle. The other options misdefine them.
52. (C) हितम् = useful and मनोहारि = pleasing. The reversal and the other options are wrong.
53. (D) सूक्तिः = a good saying and सूक्ष्म = subtle. The other pairings reverse the meanings.
54. (A) The theme is wise speech, steady effort, action over boasting, and good character. Not the fox fable, banking, or Sun-names.
55. (A) Together they teach that good things are rare/hard but achievable through steady, patient effort. Not easy, impossible, or boast-gained.
56. (D) It teaches us to act rather than merely boast. Not to boast, stay silent always, or gather wealth dishonestly.
57. (D) Curiosity (कुतूहलम्) drives the patient gathering of knowledge. It does not encourage boasting, discourage effort, or replace character.

58. (A) It means speech both useful and pleasing is rare but achievable. The other readings drop the 'both' or the 'achievable'.

59. (B) The vocabulary values good sayings, curiosity, treasured knowledge and character. Not boasting, wealth-and-pride, or inaction.

60. (D) च means 'and' (both qualities), and दुर्लभम् means rare/hard, not impossible. The other options keep one or both errors.